

NETCAT INSTALLATION & STARTUP GUIDE

1. Install Python & Dependencies

The project comes with a PowerShell script that sets up a portable Python 3.11 environment and installs all required dependencies (pyqt6, scapy, pydivert).

Open a PowerShell terminal in the project directory (d:\Netcat) and run:
`.\install_python.ps1`

2. Run the Application

Because this application captures network packets and performs active blocking, you **MUST** run it with Administrator privileges.

Open an elevated (Administrator) PowerShell terminal, navigate to d:\Netcat, and execute:
`.\python311\python.exe netcat_app.py`

3. C++ DPI Engine (Optional)

This project relies on a C++ Deep Packet Inspection (DPI) engine (dpi_engine.exe).

If you need to rebuild it, you can run:

```
.\python311\python.exe netcat_app.py --build-dpi-engine
```

Note: Compiling requires a C++ compiler (Visual Studio or MinGW) and CMake. See BUILD_STATUS.md for detailed compilation instructions.